

Parks Department Meeting February 18th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QZnbcA2OwJI
Publication Date	2025-02-19T12:52:53Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Muncie Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, February 18, 2025

Board Name: Muncie Parks and Recreation Board

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:00:47](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Board President Brad Marshall, Vice President Shannon Powers, James Lawton, Mark Irvin.
 - **Absent:** (Not explicitly stated in roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The board stood for the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:49](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the January meeting were approved by voice vote [00:01:25](#).
- **Board Reorganization:** Due to an oversight last month, the board held elections for leadership:

- **Board President:** Brad Marshall nominated and approved by voice vote [00:02:10](#).
- **Board Vice President:** Shannon Powers nominated and approved by voice vote [00:02:36](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

A. Superintendent's Report & Department Updates [00:03:06](#)

- **Presenter:** Superintendent Carl.
- **Key Updates:**
 - **Maintenance:** Crews have been busy clearing snow and managing salt levels.
 - **Muncie Teen Intern Fair Resource Center:** Held last weekend at Minnetrista with ~96 attendees. Partners included Ball State, Northwest Bank, Muncie Community Schools, Eco rehab, and local entrepreneurship groups. Workshops covered resume building, financial literacy, and career preparation.
 - **Prairie Creek Reservoir:** Staff are meeting with HR regarding seasonal hiring timelines and preparing docks.
 - **Westside Park:** Skate park construction is near completion (weather permitting). Restroom sewer backup issues are being evaluated for potential relocation or extensive repair. Softball diamond lighting and scoreboards remain on hold.
 - **Thomas Park:** Water line repairs and splash pad troubleshooting (drainage, shade/trees, algae) are planned. The power box has been safely relocated inside a fenced building. Restrooms are slated for replacement in 2025.
 - **Heekin Park:** Neighborhood requests for basketball court lighting are being reviewed alongside a quote from Walker Electric. Tennis courts have sat idle for 5 years, and options for resurfacing/pickleball/tennis are under review. Park cameras need upgrading.

B. Parks Programming & Event Approvals [00:03:19](#)

- **Presenter:** Nikki (Parks Programming) & Brandon Hayes (Third and 11).
- **Upcoming Programs & Events:**
 - Summer program registration continues, with an in-person registration weekend scheduled for March 8-9 at the Walker Event Center ([00:24:47](#)).
 - **National Kids to Park Day:** Scheduled for May 17 at Canon Commons ([00:26:07](#)).
 - **Walmart South Partnerships:** Back-to-school supply giveaway scheduled for July 22; coat drive in October culminating in a giveaway at McCulloch Cabin on November 4; Trunk or Treat scheduled for October 18 ([00:26:29](#)).
 - **NFL FLAG Football:** Brandon Hayes presented the coed K-6 program partnered with Third and 11, serving up to 120 kids free of charge thanks to sponsors and the parks department ([00:27:36](#)).

- **Event Approvals:**

1. **00:33:16 Ford Visions - 8th Annual Black Music Month Celebration:** Held June 28 at McCulloch Park. Includes live music, family activities, and \$1,000 music scholarships for middle/high school students. Security provided by Legacy Life.
 - **Action & Vote:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:37:58**.
2. **00:38:13 Muncie Chapter Black Expo:** Held July 17<U+2013>20 at Heekin Park. Features food/retail vendors, booths, and security.
 - **Action & Vote:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:40:26**.

C. Prairie Creek Reservoir Report **00:04:16**

- **Presenter:** Tom.
- **Key Updates:** Parking lot gravel refreshed; Phase 2 of Cook Education Center under way; leases sent out; seasonal hiring (6<U+2013>14 staff) starting soon; dock ice-damage assessment underway with manufacturers.
- **Event Approvals:**
 1. **00:48:16 Bass Lafayette Fishing Tournament:** July 20 (6:00 AM <U+2013> 3:00 PM), 12<U+2013>14 boats.
 - **Action & Vote:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:49:03**.
 2. **00:49:16 Indiana Walleye Anglers Fishing Tournament:** May 4 (6:00 AM <U+2013> 3:00 PM), ~20 boats.
 - **Action & Vote:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:49:44**.
 3. **00:49:50 Light Horse Club Roundup:** June 6<U+2013>8 at Indian Hill/camping area. Private club event raising funds for park trails and signage.
 - **Action & Vote:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:51:43**.
 4. **00:51:56 Jeep Roundup:** June 7 at Prairie Creek (Airplane Park area). Benefits Delaware County veterans (focusing on homeless veterans).
 - **Action & Vote (Event):** Approved by Voice Vote **00:59:03**.
 - **Action & Vote (Off-Road Trail Revision):** Approved modifying trail usage on June 7 to allow large vehicles/Jeeps only on designated ATV trails. Approved by Voice Vote **01:00:21**.
 5. **01:03:36 Harris Chapel Church of the Nazarene Easter Egg Hunt:** April 16 (6:00 PM <U+2013> 8:00 PM) at the beach area. Security by former police officer Jeremy Dy.
 - **Action & Vote:** Approved by Voice Vote **01:01:51**.

D. Old Business & Master Planning **01:02:24**

- **Presenter:** Flatland Resources (Mr. Hehman).
- **Til Pond Park:** Land and Water Conservation Fund Grant project (\$500k federal/state match + mayor's funds). Under contract; invasive species and tree clearing underway ahead of April 1 bat habitat deadline. Completion targeted for Spring 2026 **01:02:41**.

- **Prairie Creek Trails Phase 3:** Indiana Trails Program grant connecting phase 2 to the beach house. Design-build underway, targeting late fall/winter construction for a Spring 2026 opening [01:05:06](#).
- **Tuhey Park Master Planning:** Steering committee reviewing circulation, trails, and park programming in coordination with Ball State and the YMCA [01:08:41](#).
- **MLK Walk of Fame Improvements (Heekin Park):** Ziggler Foundation grant project completed concrete work. Quotes for an entrance sign range from \$8,500 (basic) to \$10,500 (ornamental). Board requested formal formal renderings and budget review before committing funds [01:11:51](#).
- **Prairie Creek Easy Docks & Leases:** Expansion of new easy docks put on hold; traditional wooden docks will be utilized for the upcoming season. Indiana Water requested non-renewal of 11<U+2013>14 individual property-adjacent docks; staff will offer these dock holders open reservoir docks in good standing before opening to the general public lottery [01:17:22](#).

E. New Business [01:02:24](#)

- **Conflict of Interest Training:** Rescheduled by Patty (Ethics Committee) for a future meeting [01:24:32](#).
- **YMCA Pool Contract Review:** Initial 2025 budget and staffing cost summaries (\$6,617 net operating increase proposed) were presented for preliminary review. Board members questioned figures relative to prior operational periods; further review scheduled [01:25:32](#).
- **Security Pros Surveillance System Proposal:** Sam Sohaky presented proposals for automated access control/doors at Tuhey Park restrooms and upgraded, high-mounted AI/infrared surveillance cameras with 911 dispatch integration options at Heekin Park and Tuhey pool [01:29:41](#).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: Formal public comment was integrated into specific agenda items (e.g., Brandon Hayes for NFL Flag Football [01:27:36](#), William McIntosh for Ford Visions [01:33:34](#), Tom for reservoir events, and Sam Sohaky for security proposals [01:29:41](#)). No distinct open floor citizen forum was held at the conclusion of the meeting.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:** Future meetings will continue tracking the YMCA contract, security proposals, and master plan updates.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by motion and voice vote [01:40:44](#).
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-30 02:17:33 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.